

# Working in space

We have all seen workers on a construction site, hammering and drilling. Imagine a construction site floating in space high above the Earth's surface. That's what astronauts have to cope with when they are repairing a satellite, or putting together a space station.

The International Space Station (ISS) seen from the space shuttle *Discovery*.



## Is it warm today?

In orbit, the strong sunshine heats astronauts up. Surprisingly, it's difficult to lose heat in space, so spacesuits have to include a refrigeration unit!



Illustration of how a sunrise would look from space.

An astronaut may be outside the space station for hours at a time. This one is working on the station's robotic arm.

Between 1998 and 2005, more than 60 spacewalks were performed. Each time two astronauts worked on the International Space Station.

### Hands on

Astronauts say that moving their hands in their gloves is difficult. To feel what they mean, put a rubber band around your closed fingers and try to open them. Do this fifteen times.